Q+A

Different Strokes

Alia Bhatt turns author with her first children's book, *Ed Finds a Home*



Q. How did you find the time to write a book?

I've always considered myself a storyteller, and the idea for the books actually came before the brand [Ed-a-Mamma]. I've always wanted to write for children, creating a series of books that promote kindness towards one another, animals and nature. I brought in my co-storytellers, Vivek Kamath and Shabnam Minwalla, to help me put this idea on paper.

Q. The main character is a little girl called Alia. So is it autobiographical?

When Shaheen and I were kids, we were always rescuing animals from the streets, much to my mom's dismay. Nevertheless, she always provided the best temporary home for them. This nurturing, kindness, and care are also evident in the family life of little Alia. Her journey isn't based on my life, but certain elements of my childhood have been incorporated into this story.

Q. What is the single-most challenging thing about motherhood for you?

Being an actor involves a lot of travel, long hours on set and work commitments, which sometimes conflict with my desire to be present for every milestone and moment in Raha's life. But I'm learning to prioritise and cherish every moment, both on screen and off.

Q. What are you working on right now?

The second book! I have always envisioned Ed-a-Mamma as a universe of products for children, all rooted in storytelling. There's even an animation series in the works. On the movie front, I've got some exciting projects. *Jigra*, on which I'm also a co-producer, will be released on October 11. And I can't wait to get started on *Love & War*. It's truly an honour to work with and learn from Sanjay Sir again.

–with Amit Dixit